Face-to-face conversation isn’t so easy to directly measure with agile tools used today. But you can measure the amount of communication through comments captured in your systems at various points in the delivery flow and cross-reference those with arbitrary tags and labels in your PTS to figure out what level of measureable communication works best for your team:

- PTS and SCM comment counts, as noted previously, imply how well collaboration is going.
- Cross-reference these comment counts with labels and tags on tasks that your team uses to indicate if they think communication is working well.

Your team is building the software through agile processes; measuring how well your team works together is the next set of agile principles we’ll take a look at.

10.4. Four principles for an effective team

The next group of four answers the question “Is your development team effective?”

- The best architectures, requirements, and designs emerge from self-organizing teams.
- Business people and developers must work together daily throughout the project.
- Build projects around motivated individuals. Give them the environment and support they need, and trust them to get the job done.
- At regular intervals, the team reflects on how to become more effective and then tunes and adjusts its behavior accordingly.

These principles are all people issues: how well your team works together, how motivated they are, your level of autonomy, and how well you can check and adjust. How well your team is working together affects many of your other metrics. How quickly tasks go through your workflow, how much code is written per task, how many bugs turn up, and how tasks move